

Customer Notification and Communication Standard

AfaqRoute Logistics Services Co. (ARLS) | Saudi Arabia Operations

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Purpose

To ensure exception communications are factual, concise, actionable and consistent across account teams and the Control Tower.

Scope

Applies to customer-facing shipment updates sent by email, portal, messaging channels or account-management teams.

1. Required message structure

- Shipment reference and route.
- Current confirmed status and location.
- Confirmed exception/root cause, or clear statement that cause is pending confirmation.
- Impact on promised delivery or ETA.
- Action being taken and responsible party.
- Any customer action required.
- Next update time.

2. Wording controls

Avoid	Use instead
'Customs will release today' without evidence	'Release timing is pending confirmation from the clearance party.'
'Carrier is at fault' before validation	'The delay is under investigation with the carrier.'
'No issue' when SLA is at risk	'Shipment remains in motion; delivery commitment is at risk.'
Internal technical code only	Plain-language explanation plus reference if needed.

3. Update cadence

Severity	Minimum update cadence
Routine exception, no SLA risk	At material change or agreed checkpoint
SLA at risk	Every 4 hours during operating window
SLA breached / customs hold >24h	At least daily and at material change
High-value or security event	As directed by incident owner

Records and audit trail

All material actions, timestamps, approvals, customer notifications and supporting evidence must be recorded against the shipment or incident reference in the transport management system.

Control note

This internal document does not replace Saudi laws, customs instructions, carrier terms, customer contracts or directions issued by competent authorities.